3. Start to automate parts of the contract and agreement processes. This might mean that Messflix has a simple way of providing access policies via the GUI or that Messflix calculates standard metrics for the data products that can be compared to SLAs.

   *The output of step 3 should be that the contracts and agreements feel easy to use and add a benefit to the participating parties.*

As you can see, with step 3, the implementation and automation blend together with the data catalog. Once the cultural shift is in place, mutual collaboration kicks in and becomes a natural part of the self-serve platform and its roadmap.

In this section, we presented tools and techniques to describe a data product so that it can be understood by others (metadata) and used to connect to other data products (FAIR principles). As you can see, creating a useful data product requires a well-thought-out design, established rules, and a set of tools to create them efficiently.

Although we've showed how to design and craft a data product, creating an ecosystem of data products will require standardization of rules for creating and describing those data products, which will be the responsibility of the data governance team. It will also be required to provide a whole set of tools to support teams creating new data products, which will be enabled by the self-serve platform. We will also need strategies for transforming the architecture of existing systems and data into data products. These topics are addressed in subsequent chapters.

## *Summary*

- To make data valuable, we should treat it as more than just an asset.
- To treat data as a product, we apply product thinking to it.
- Data products should be created with users in mind.
- A data product should address clearly defined user needs.
- A data product is an autonomous, read-optimized, standardized data unit, a node in the data mesh architecture, containing at least one